

Aurélien Pocheville

🇫🇷 French (Native)
🇬🇧 English (TOEIC: 935)
🇯🇵 Japanese (JLPT: N2)
🏠 Remote, France (GMT+1/+2)
☎ +33 7 56 86 90 09
✉ work@slurdge.org

🐙 github.com/slurdge [in linkedin.com/pocheville](https://www.linkedin.com/company/pocheville) [🌐 slurdge.org](https://slurdge.org)

About



I work with founders, executives and technical teams when the product is ambitious, the technology is unclear, or the delivery risk is high.

I have spent more than 20 years building engineering teams, shipping complex software products, and turning R&D into production. At Nintendo European R&D, I created the original concept for the [NES Classic Edition](#), built the core emulation team, and led the technical work through launch in close coordination with Nintendo Japan.

Since leaving Nintendo, I have worked as CTO, transition CTO and fractional CTO for game studios, startups and technology companies. My work covers technical roadmap, architecture, team structure, AI integration, cloud/devops, production tooling, security, Unity/Unreal projects and delivery recovery.

I am technical enough to debug hard problems myself, but most of my value is helping teams decide what matters, what does not, and how to move again.

⚡ Selected impact

- Created the original concept for the [NES Classic Edition](#) and led its technical direction from early idea to shipped product.
- Built and managed a core emulation team of 10 engineers, with broader technical decision-making across 15 people.
- Led from-scratch emulator development under severe timing constraints, with accuracy to original NES hardware behavior as the main technical risk.
- Worked directly with Nintendo Japan project leadership and decision-makers.
- Created the Nintendo DS emulator for Wii U, later used globally across 30+ Virtual Console titles.
- Stabilized production pipelines for shipped multi-platform games across console, desktop and Linux platforms.
- Reduced delivery risk by introducing CI/CD, build orchestration and internal production tooling where none existed.
- Advised startups and studios as CTO or fractional CTO on roadmap, architecture, outsourced teams, AI, infrastructure, security and prioritization.

★ Experience and projects

2023-Present

Fractional CTO, freelance and contract work

- Game porting, optimization and production pipeline for [Tuesday Quest](#)
 - Led porting and technical production work for *A Planet of Mine: Mastermind Edition*.
 - Built and stabilized the cross-platform pipeline for Nintendo Switch, Windows, macOS and Linux.
 - Improved the shipped product from 30 fps to 60 fps.
 - Rebuilt the save architecture, reducing representative save time from around 1s to 5ms.
 - Created internal tools for localization, asset generation, save inspection, scenario editing, build orchestration and content synchronization.

- Introduced CI/CD where none existed, reducing broken builds from more than 10 per month to fewer than 1.
- Consulting CTO for [Hakuro](#)
 - Advised leadership as consulting CTO.
 - Reviewed and guided the work of a 10-person outsourced engineering team once to twice a week.
 - Joined key stakeholder meetings and helped translate business and product decisions into technical work.
 - Worked on AI-assisted task classification during exploration phase.
- Consulting for [EverreachLab](#)
 - Reviewed Unreal engineering work and external technical team delivery.
 - Advised on AWS, devops and infrastructure decisions.
 - Participated in executive-level discussions.
 - Helped frame the practical issues of integrating Web2 and Web3 systems into a common architecture.
- Transition CTO for Mainbot, EdTech startup
 - Four-month transition CTO mission.
 - Reviewed R&D roadmap, product priorities and technical organization.
 - Refocused the company's technical priorities around the core education proof of concept.
 - Managed technical staff and infrastructure priorities during the transition.
- Security consulting for [Nemorius](#)
 - Infrastructure audit and pentest.
 - Code review on selected parts of the system.
 - Practical security recommendations based on real deployment constraints.

2017-2023

Technology consulting, freelance and contract work

- Consulting for UnitedBits
 - Technical stack assessment.
 - Feasibility studies.
 - Roadmap and architecture recommendations.
- Contract work for Forever Entertainment, *Front Mission 1st: Remake*
 - Reverse engineering work to support technical decisions.
 - Unity architecture work.
- Security consulting and vulnerability research
 - Rewarded for finding flaws in [Cal.com](#).
 - Focused on business-impacting issues rather than theoretical security problems.
- Consulting for Publicis, confidential project with a global leader in cosmetics
 - AI and deep learning.
 - Tensorflow and Keras.
 - Technical advisory on applied machine learning use cases.
- Freelance work for a video publishing company
 - Technical consulting.
 - R&D management.
- Freelance work on a Unity serious game
 - Rebuilt the architecture, build system and asset pipeline.
 - Took the project from demo to shipped product in under 2 months.
 - Delivered the project with positive client feedback.
- Security and embedded systems consulting
 - Reviewed real-world systems from both architecture and attacker perspectives.
 - Worked on infrastructure security, code review, reverse engineering and embedded systems.
 - Presented NFC security research at [Pass The Salt 2019](#).
- Consulting for independent video game companies
 - Technical advisory.

- Architecture and production support.

2020-2021

Chief Technical Officer at LightbulbCrew

- Led a 6-person engineering team across 2 projects.
- Owned the technical roadmap, hiring plan, engineering budget and vendor management.
- Created a new recruitment process for engineering, with better technical signal and fewer weak hires.
- Reduced onboarding time and build failures.
- Performed technical mentoring and education of employees.
- Participated in executive strategy.
- Supervised the technical stack for Unity and Unreal games.
 - Procedural environment R&D with Houdini and Unreal.
 - Cloud-agnostic CI/CD infrastructure.
 - Data pipeline.
 - Consolidation of infrastructure in a remote-first context.

2020

Entrepreneur/CTO at Entrepreneur First

- Selected for a 60-person cohort from thousands of applicants.
- Created NimbleApp, a productivity solution for Sales & Marketing teams.

2011-2017

Nintendo European R&D — Chief Innovation Officer, France & Japan

- Acted as Head of R&D and technical director for innovation projects.
- Created the original concept for the NES Classic Edition and led its technical direction through launch.
- Built most of the emulation team from scratch: 10 direct reports, with broader technical decision-making across roughly 15 people.
- Officially owned the emulator while also contributing to CPU selection, Linux kernel foundations, debugging tools, QA tools and external QA coordination.
- Led from-scratch NES emulator development under severe schedule constraints.
- Focused the emulator work on accuracy to original hardware behavior, including original hardware bugs.
- Created a replay tool allowing emulated game sessions to be replayed on real NES hardware.
- Worked directly with Nintendo Japan project leadership and key decision-makers.
- Led the Nintendo DS emulator for Wii U, covering architecture, management, emulator design, tooling, delivery and stakeholder communication.
- Shipped the Nintendo DS emulator globally across 30+ Wii U Virtual Console titles.
- Solved the core DS emulator problem: mapping Nintendo DS hardware behavior, including its GBA heritage, dual processors, GPU behavior and coprocessors, onto Wii U hardware.
- Created a multi-platform Rapid Application Development framework, used most notably in Nintendo Anime Channel.
- Put in place processes, tools and team management methods.
- Conducted business intelligence and innovation work.
- Organized hackathons.

2007-2011

Wizarbox — Platform and game engine developer

- Worked on multiple console and PC titles across Nintendo DS, Wii, Nintendo 3DS, Xbox 360, PS3 and PC.
- Built adventure game engine technology and tools for DS, Wii, PC and PS3.
- Worked on engine optimization, porting and Lua scripting integration.

2003-2007

IBISC — PhD student

- Research in high-fidelity virtual reality, haptics and physics simulation.
- Published internationally at IROS, HAVE and ICRA.
- Built thermal haptic devices and a constraint-based physics engine.

Skills

CTO and leadership

Fractional CTO, transition CTO, technical roadmap, engineering leadership, hiring process, vendor management, executive reporting, stakeholder communication.

Technical strategy

Architecture review, feasibility studies, product risk assessment, infrastructure decisions, production recovery, technical prioritization.

Engineering management

Engineering team management, outsourced team oversight, project planning, mentoring, recruitment, weekly and monthly reporting.

Game and platform technology

Emulation, game engines, Unity, Unreal, console platforms, porting, performance optimization, production pipelines, build systems.

Cloud, devops and tooling

CI/CD, AWS, Docker, Linux, data pipelines, build orchestration, internal tools, localization tools, asset pipelines.

AI and security

Applied AI, deep learning, Tensorflow, Keras, task classification, security audit, pentest, code review, NFC security.

Programming

C++, C#, C, Python, Go, Lua, embedded systems, ARM microcontrollers, reverse engineering.

Languages

French native, English fluent, Japanese professional working proficiency.

Education

2003-2007

PhD student in high-fidelity virtual reality and haptics.
Haptics studies touch sensation and its applications in virtual reality.

2000-2003

ENSIEE — Engineering degree in Computer Science, diploma in 2003.

1997-2000

Preparatory classes in Mathematics & Physics.

Always find the most up to date version of this document <https://cv.pocheville.eu/> or scan



PDF Version